

# Paper Moons of Caldera

Fictional Movie Catalog

2026

## Catalog Metadata

**Release date:** November 6, 2026

**Runtime:** 102 minutes

**Genres:** Animation, Family, Science Fiction

**Director:** Lumi Aster

**Writers:** Priya Noll and Evan Moss

**Top cast:** Aya Lin as Niko; Marco Day as Dr. Sol; June Kestrel as Pip; Rafi Bloom as Commander Vale.

**Mock IMDb rating:** 8.0 from 12,780 votes

## Synopsis

Twelve-year-old Niko lives in Caldera Station, a research colony suspended above a volcanic planet. She folds paper models of the planet's tiny moons and maps their paths across her bedroom ceiling. When her mother's survey ship loses navigation during an ash eruption, official instruments cannot see through the charged clouds.

Niko notices that her paper moons drift whenever magnetic waves pass through the station. With help from the maintenance robot Pip, she builds a fleet of lightweight signal gliders based on her models. The gliders form a moving constellation that the lost crew can follow home. Commander Vale initially dismisses the plan, but Niko's careful observations reveal a safe route no computer model has considered.

## Themes and Style

The film celebrates curiosity, craft, and young people whose knowledge is overlooked because it arrives in an unexpected form. Hand-painted paper textures appear throughout the computer animation. The volcanic clouds shift from threatening charcoal shapes to a luminous night sky as Niko learns to trust her own method.

## Production Notes

Artists built physical origami models for every spacecraft before animation began. The score blends a children's choir with sounds recorded from folding paper. The fictional production is rated PG for mild peril and emotional themes.